

2.1.23 Master / Slave

Since a PATA controller allows two devices to be connected to the same channel, one has to be designated the “Master” and the other the “Slave” to avoid data being wrongly routed. This is just a convention—the drives could as well be termed “first” and “second.”

2.1.24 MBR

The Master Boot Record resides in the first sector of the hard disk. This contains critical information like the Master Partition Table and the information about the active partition.

2.1.25 MTBF

Mean Time Before Failure is the average life of the hard disk expressed in hours of usage.

2.1.26 NCQ

Native Command Queuing is a feature of SATA hard drives. This allows read / write requests made to the hard disk to be re-ordered to use the movements of the internal components more efficiently, leading to lower waiting periods.

2.1.27 Partition Table

A Partition is a logical subdivision of a hard disk into smaller chunks. The partition table is the record of the partitions on a hard disk. There are two types of partition tables. The Master Partition Table forms part of the MBR, and can carry details of only four partitions. The need for more than four partitions was met by allowing the creation of an Extended Partition Table, which could contain an unlimited number of partition entries (though the letters in the alphabet limits this number to 24). The Master Partition Table contains a reference to the Extended Partition Table.

2.1.28 PATA

The original ATA standard had to be called PATA (for Parallel ATA) after the advent of Serial ATA for sake of differentiation. PATA refers to an interface used for connecting hard disk and optical drives to the system. It used the parallel mode of data transfer,